# ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY

# ARGUMENTATION

- The aim of writing argumentative essays is to convince or persuade the reader.
- One attempts to change the reader's mind and convince the reader to agree with the point of view or claim of the writer.
- So an argumentative essay needs to be highly persuasive and logical.

# Key Terms to Learn (p. 112)

Argumentation ___2___

Refutation ___5___

Proponent ___6___

Opponent ___1___

Counter Argument (CON) ___4___

Pro Argument (PRO) ___3___

1. a person who disagrees with something and speaks against it
2. the act or process of forming reasons, drawing conclusions, and applying them to a case in discussion
3. point or statement that supports one's ideas and/or thesis
4. point or statement in opposition to the argument being made in a written document or speech
5. the process of discrediting the arguments that oppose your thesis statement
6. someone who argues in favor of something; advocate

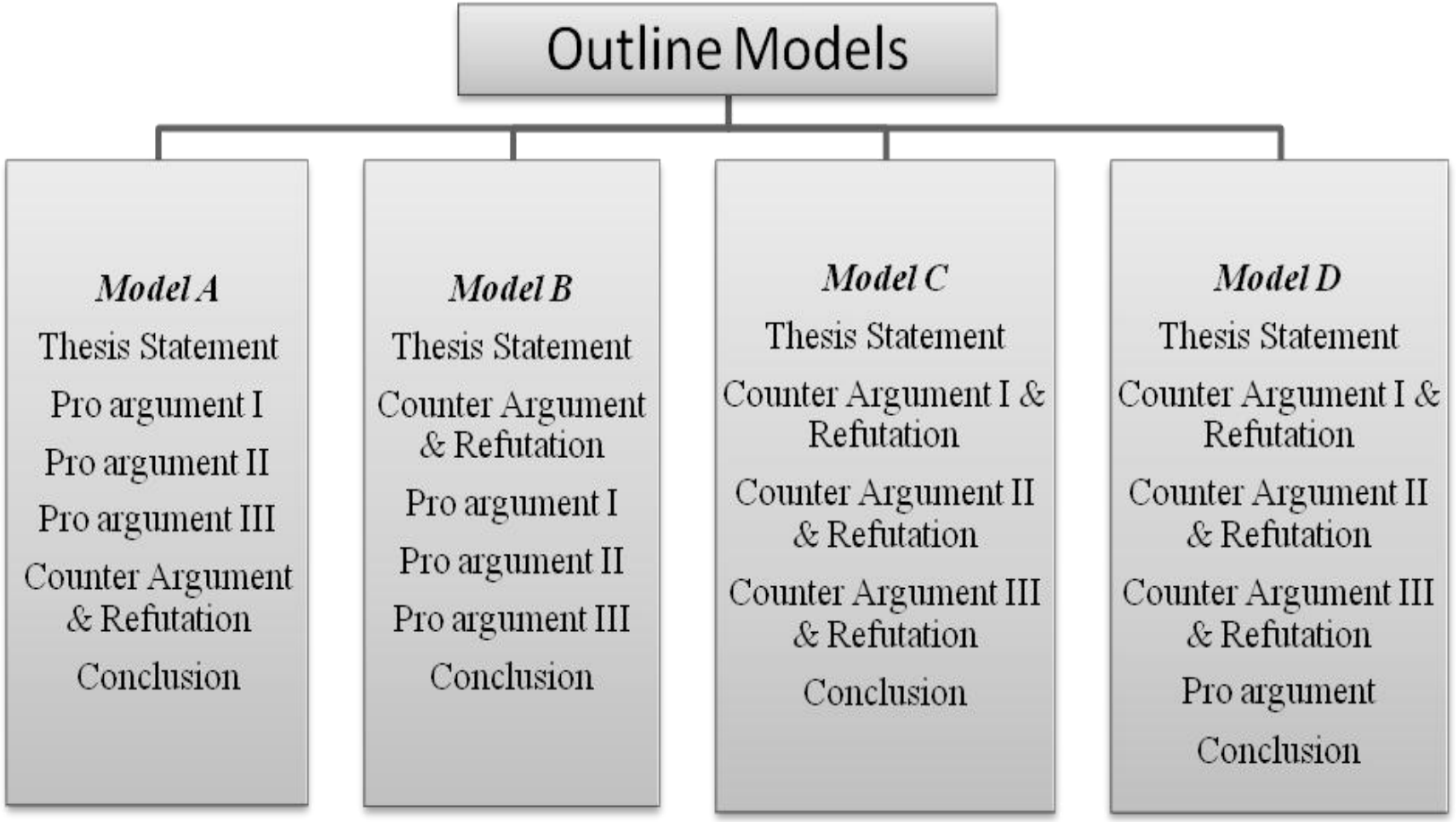
# The Purpose of Argumentative Essay is to:

- present an opinion on a controversial topic to the reader;
- explain, clarify and illustrate that opinion;
- persuade the reader that the opinion supported in the essay is valid by:
    a. moving the reader to action,
    b. convincing the reader that the opinion is correct, or
    c. persuading the reader that the opinion is at least worth considering;
- support the opinion by means of giving *evidence*: facts, examples, physical description, support of authority, and statistics;
- present counterarguments to the thesis and refute them respectfully and critically.

# How to Create an outline

- Find a debatable topic.
- Word your thesis carefully to provoke thought or action.
- Do research.
- Make a pro-con chart.
- Outline your arguments so that they are focused and organized.
- Anticipate objections and differing viewpoints and show why your argument is stronger even if the others have some merit.
- Support all your claims with convincing evidence and reasoned analysis.
- Avoid logical fallacies; weak arguments.

# STAGE 3: ORGANIZING IDEAS INTO AN OUTLINE



# ADVERTISING MANIPULATES VIEWERS

A Sample Argumentative Essay

# Sample Essay - Introduction

**ADVERTISING MANIPULATES VIEWERS**

In the simplest form, advertising can be defined as a kind of message or message transmission that is designed to promote a product, service, or an idea.

→ definition

Today this basic marketing strategy has become a natural part of our daily life. Considering that the $ 20 billion spent on advertisements in 1979 had drastically risen to $120 billion in 1999 and that in the course of a lifetime, one will see about three years worth of advertisements on television and approximately 3,000 ads per day, a person may easily acknowledge the impact of advertising (DiChiara, 2008, para. 3).

→ facts

Nonetheless, as Giselle Touzard (2008) explains, advertising, which originally intended to be a source of information for people on the availability of products, "has developed into an industry that shapes people's identity" (para. 2). Coming in various forms – in print, audio, or visual form – advertisements not only bombard audience with their messages, but they also sell the ideas of who we are and what we should do or be.

→ authority's opinion

**Thus, advertisements are harmful for the society owing to their disruptive influence.**

→ Thesis statement

# Introduction

- General Statement: In the simplest form, advertising can be defined as a kind of message or message transmission that is designed to promote a product, service, or an idea.

# Specific Statement

- Specific Statement:

Nonetheless, as Giselle Touzard (2008) explains, advertising, which originally intended to be a source of information for people on the availability of products, “has developed into an industry that shapes people’s identity” (para. 2). Coming in various forms – in print, audio, or visual form – advertisements not only bombard audience with their messages, but they also sell the ideas of who we are and what we should do or be.

# Purpose Thesis Statement

Thesis Statement:

Purpose of this essay is to argue on advertisements are harmful for the society owing to their disruptive influence.

# Contradictory Ideas/Against Ideas

- Against Ideas

Some may argue that advertisements are beneficial. It is the contention of these supporters that advertisements are essential in keeping the market alive and rivalry hot. They believe that it is thanks to advertisements that companies working on the same line can display their products on the market equally and fairly.

# For Ideas

- However, this idea cannot go further than being an immature claim because this rivalry is unfair. It is only the companies who can “afford” broadcasting strong propaganda of their product that can actually survive in this competitive environment. In that sense, small companies are destined to be wiped out from the market.

# For Argumnets

This point has merits on the surface and could be acceptable to an extent. It is true that advertisements inform the consumers on the availability and variety of goods. Yet, serious doubts can be raised against this view when one considers the shortcomings of the messages the viewers are exposed to.

# For Arguments

- The target audience, that is the consumers, are forced to believe in illusions about the product rather than realities. When an advertiser focuses merely on the advantages of a product, it creates a false impression. Or when a commodity is equated with positive feelings such as happiness and self-confidence, this image builds up a false hope that once you buy it, you will be happy and self-confident.
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# For Arguments

- Eventually, when these illusions are not realized – as they have been lies of the advertiser all along -, the consumer is disappointed. The advertiser achieves the ultimate end and turns a gear in the consumer society, but it is a deception that is ethically unacceptable. The advertiser not only pushes the public deeper into consumption, but also disillusions it with false messages.

# Conclusion

- Restate Title
- ReState Thesis Statement
- Sum-up main ideas
- The conclusion one needs to draw from these is that advertisements are detrimental.
- Recommnedation